ECHOSPOT

DECO3500 Social & Mobile Computing · Team 10 Watermelon

Leave your sound where you stand

Walk there to hear it. Answer with a song.

EchoSpot pins music and sound to the real place it belongs. An echo only plays when you are standing where it was left, and the only way to reply is with another song.

01 The problem

People already listen everywhere: at a bus stop, in a restaurant, by the lake. But that moment is private. The next person at that stop has no idea a song belonged there. Same place, different time, and they never meet. Spotify recommends by algorithm; Google Maps describes places with stars.



Visible from anywhere. Playable only where it was left.

02 What we heard in 14 interviews

Songs stick to places.
“The place. Definitely the place. My mood changes every day but that bus stop doesn’t.”

A trace needs a person and a reason.
“A song with nobody behind it… it’s the same as an algorithm to me.”

Strangers make people listen harder.
“With a stranger I’d have no idea, so I’d actually listen properly.”

People want to answer, but hold back.
“I thought about writing ‘No, it doesn’t’ underneath it, but that seemed a bit rude.”

03 How it works: one echo, two people, different times

The social unit isn’t a person. It’s a place.

1 Leave
Listener A, today

Record a sound or attach a track, label what kind of audio it is, and add one line on why you left it here.

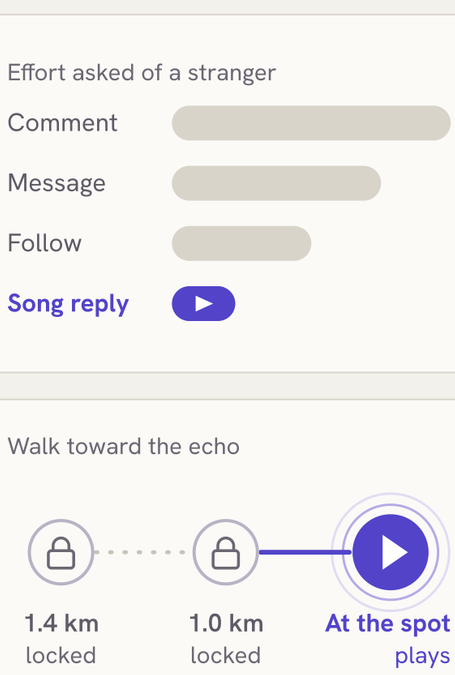
2 Walk there
Listener B, days later

Echoes show on the map, locked. Walk to the spot to unlock it and hear it where it was meant to be heard.

3 Answer in music

No profiles, followers or comments. B replies the way A spoke: with a song. A sees it was played and what came back.

04 Lessons in social & mobile



SOCIAL

Lighter is better between strangers.

Testers wanted to reply, but not to “contact them properly”. One tap with a song asks less of a stranger than a comment.

MOBILE

Where you stand is the interface.

Distance, not search, decides what you hear. All three finders refused a wider radius, and a song stays a link, not a file.

Social without profiles, mobile without search: let the place do the introducing.

05 What testing changed

~~Browse anything in range~~ → **Plays only when you’re there**
All three finders refused to widen the radius: “I could do that in any music app.”

~~Upload an audio file~~ → **Attach a track, or record your own**
“The song is in Spotify, not in my Files app.”

~~Title and mood icon~~ → **Audio type + why I left it here**
One finder expected a song, found nine seconds of humming, and opened nothing else.

~~A heart~~ → **One-tap reply with a song + play count**
“I don’t need to contact them properly. That would be too much for a stranger.”

Leave a sound before you go.

Yiqin Cai · Lingjie Ruan · Xiru Wen · Jie Wen · Chuxin Zhang

Scan to try the prototype
EchoSpot, open in your browser
xiruwen.github.io/DECO3500_group_watermelon/EchoSpot